Indo–Pacific. It also attempted to reach out to new constituencies, including in business, technology, and new geographies. Various domestic Indian policies had international implications after Modi's reelection in 2019 but were overtaken by three major crises: the Covid-19 pandemic, India–China border clashes, and Russia's war in Ukraine. India's extended region also saw significant turmoil, including in Afghanistan, Sri Lanka, Myanmar Bangladesh, and West Asia (the Middle East). Despite these complications, India continued to invest in closer relations with the United States and its allies and partners in Europe, Asia, the Gulf, and Israel, while attempting to preserve ties with Russia and Iran. India's trade, technology, defence, and industrial policies also transformed in response to growing competition with China. Finally, India renewed its attempts at reaching out to the Global South and sought to lead multilateral negotiating efforts at the G20.

The period after 1991, therefore, witnessed some major changes to India's interactions with the world: from a closed economy to a more open, integrated, and competitive one; from deep distrust of the United States and its allies and partners to a closer and more cooperative set of partnerships; from a narrow conception of its region as South Asia to a wider role in the Indo–Pacific balance of power; from the rhetoric of third-worldism to that of a rising power; and from a preoccupation with Pakistan to a greater priority on the long-term and structural challenges posed by China's rise and assertiveness. This, in summary, represents India's realignment in international affairs in the post-Cold War world.

Part II: Strategy is more prescriptive than descriptive. It is intended to highlight the main strategic challenges facing India today and offer policy priorities to address them. India's five major objectives are: (i) accelerating its domestic development and thereby improving the fundamentals of its power, (ii) ensuring a stable periphery in its neighbourhood, (iii) balancing China in the Indo–Pacific, (iv) reshaping West Asia despite continuing problems emanating from Pakistan and (v) restructuring international institutions and organizations to advance Indian interests.

Chapter 6: Atmanirbhar Bharat describes how India can develop its domestic capabilities by investing in military preparedness (including